Cruising with Craft to the Ends of the Worlds: Practices of shattering, becoming scyborg and dancing with dragons as possible cartographies
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I spend days and weeks on the couch doing nothing useful for society and getting high. High on the ability to forget about the world as I stone. Sorting the crystals, the hematite, the quartz and the rhinestones I met in the markets, jumbled and mismatched in dirty bags and sold as is. Cleaning and mending, finding a place for each one to rest.Yet all that I do has only hoisted me higher. A disco ball to dance under but never to be heard. A celestial space that doesn't feel so heavenly.

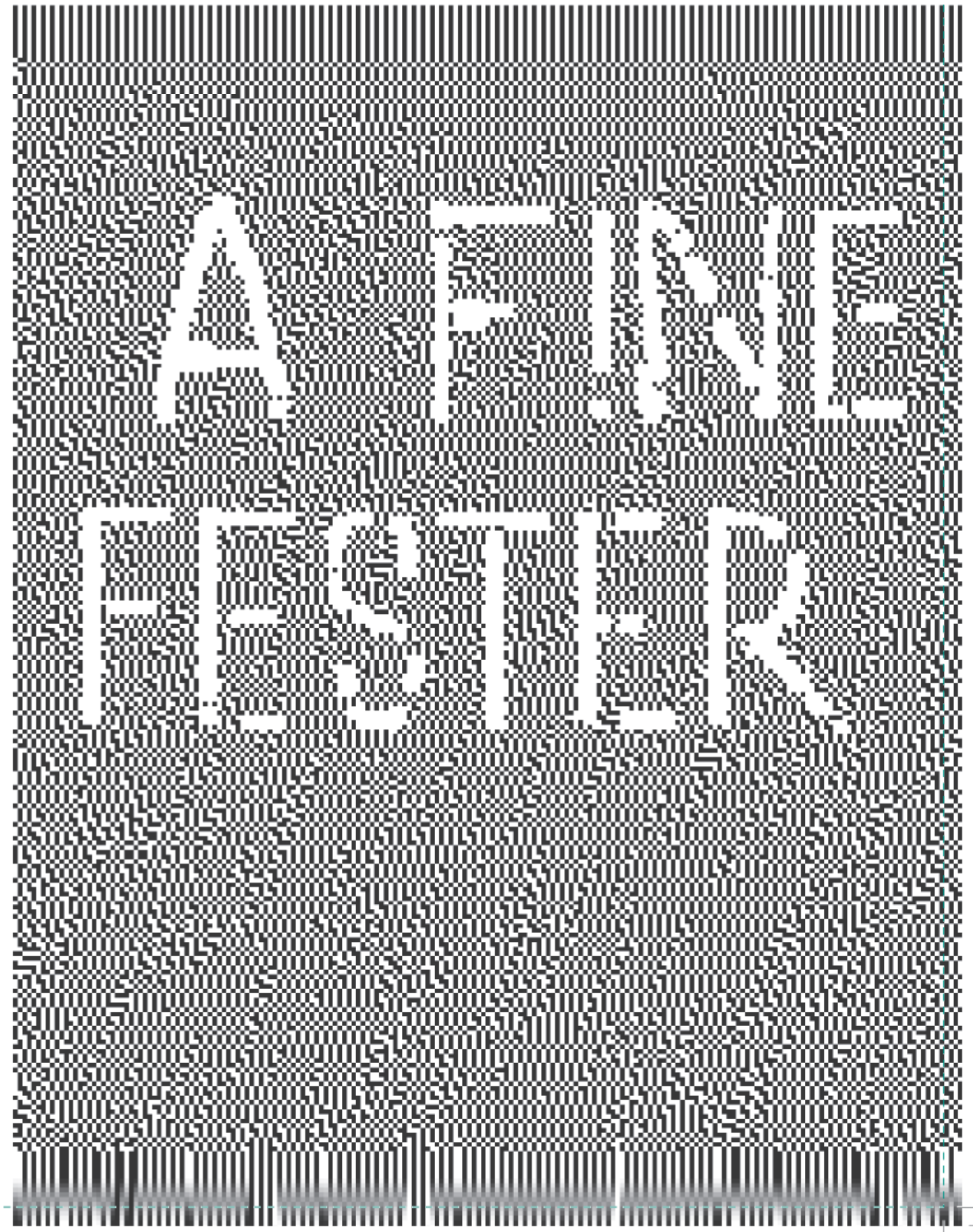
A tether to watch the bodies below move as they please. Dancing in the dark of the club being who they want, how they want with who they want. It still makes me sad how they lock it all away when they leave and step back out where they can be seen. But at least they don't think about their safety while they walk back home.

This is not what I meant when I said transness for me is a constant state of possible motion.I keep writing to José Esteban Muñoz to ask if spinning in a circle is still a movement to the horizon. They complain I won't shut up as I ask for the same things over and over. Freedom, liberation and equity for us all. I wouldn't have to talk in circles if they would just let me down and stop me from spinning. Instead they just bring others different from me and different from them, left to perpetually spin together for their pleasure.

Did they not realize we could become kin?
Why would they, solidarity is a foreign concept, and they
hate foreigners.

I am exhausted I say and am replied to about my ungratefulness to be given a place to rest. A precarious place with no privacy and no way to find home.

How sad to say…
at least
I am not
alone.



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DEAD AS DISCO

I have researched for years: war rooms, living rooms, dance clubs, tool sheds, garages and bedrooms. Creating spaces of rest, storage and activation. Implicating the presence of being(s) moving into various states and flows. A child of the working class American midwest and Canadian woodlands I was told the freedom of movement and rest were mine.

One day while running between these spaces I slipped on that patch of floor I usually jump over or dart around. I never knew how to clean it up, I just avoided it. I suppose it was inevitable by ignoring it that I would one day slide and bust my ass in the slick yet sticky mess of gender. Before I could even blink my body was placed in a sling and hoisted like a broken limb in need of elevation.

I was broken.
I was shattered.

Shattering the black and brown feminists like bell hooks and Sara Ahmed wrote me is part of this life. A constant reconfiguring as a process of love and the outside forces of oppression. An action that can be both liberating and scarring. A broken moment for joy and a chance to let the light and fresh air into the cracks. But mother only sees something that must be mended. The news has whispered to her the stories of predatory drag queens and trans bathroom creeps.

I scream out the open window in hopes someone hears. But when someone looks in to see if i'm ok they just laugh, smile or take a picture for their social media stories like a visitor at the zoo. I am just a spectacle to them. A drag queen on a runway that is not human under it all. I am as seen on tv. Something that dresses and acts for the reaction of others. A spectacle to behold not a human needing to be held. The cage is only clean where visitors can see.

Like a dead animal in a still life. The ones hanging in national museums of rabbits with their ankles nailed to the wall, the hunting dog sitting below. Bodies piled, hooked and tied while a butcher begins his work or some aristocrat sits and stares out in contemplation. A body hanging for the joy and expression of power for another. Could they at least wipe the pearls of spit dripping from my mouth while I rot for their pleasure.

The problem will be my stench as I rot,
not that they hunted me in the first place.

I've done everything I can to get out of this sling. Learned jewelry and leather, flameworked glass flowers and carved semi-precious stones. Made deals with strange men for the porcelain flowers in their basements of the factories they have bought, now destined for the great project of gentrification. Ripped seams to repurpose old dresses and my grandmother's bead work and restored damaged mid-century modern antiques destined for the trash. I've learned to use the discarded and replicate it without telling you which is which and learned that Dolly Parton was right.

It does take a lot of money to look this cheap.

I've scrimped and scraped to save, unlike that youth pastor my mother obsessed over who did anything but while he was "saving". I've poured cocktails and baked bread for my dollars while they walk past thinking all I do is play with cock and break bread. But when mother asks I can not lie as it is true...

... I am a stoner.



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